Read with audio

Step 2: two free sources, one method, a 4-week schedule

Two free sources, nothing else

Source	Level	Why	Link
MeloLingua: Il Caffè della Mattina, Al Mercato, Il Gelato Perfetto, In Treno verso Firenze, La Cena della Nonna	A1	Native audio, glossary and comprehension questions, about 600 words total. No signup for these 5 stories.	Open stories
The Fable Cottage: Cenerentola, Biancaneve, Hansel e Gretel, Jack e il fagiolo magico, I tre capretti furbetti and 5 more	A1–A2	Italian + English text with audio, most with animated video. 10 free stories.	Story list · Cenerentola

Method (10–15 min per story section)

- **1. Read and listen at once.** Follow the text while the audio plays. Do not stop.
- **2. Cognate scan.** Underline every word you recognised from English. You understand more than you think.
- **3. Read again, aloud.** Look up at most 5 words. Write whole chunks, not single words.
- **4. Retell.** Close it and say what happened in 4–6 sentences. Say it badly; that is the point.

Schedule

Week	Read
1	MeloLingua: Il Caffè della Mattina, Al Mercato, Il Gelato Perfetto
2	MeloLingua: In Treno verso Firenze, La Cena della Nonna. Then re-read your favourite one with no English.
3	Fable Cottage: Cenerentola and I tre capretti furbetti
4	Fable Cottage: Biancaneve and one more of your choice. [B1] Retell it in 8 sentences and record yourself.

Reading log

Story	Chunks I learned (write 5)	My retelling in one sentence